translation to participate in meetings without language friction.

"The employees had no problem participating or expressing themselves. They simply wanted a tool that allowed them to respond in a language they were comfortable with," says Rassense's Kumar. "If a platform cannot work easily with translation tools, perhaps it is the platform and the process that need to evolve rather than expecting every employee to adapt to one language."

In management education too, AI can translate course material into regional languages, lowering the friction of accessing complex subjects without restructuring degree tracks.

However, experts unanimously caution that while AI can remove reading and translation barriers, it cannot replace the core interpersonal attributes required for senior corporate leadership.

"AI translation and other communication technologies can reduce language friction in meetings and documents," says TalentiFi-X's Mangalwedhe. "But they do not replace the person who has to persuade, build trust, and take a decision in real time with global stakeholders. English will stop being the filter for many white-collar jobs as skills-based hiring and AI-enabled communication become more common. At the top, however, strong English communication will still remain an important leadership skill." says Mangalwedhe.

THE NEXT GENERATION

When organisations use polished English as an initial screen, they risk eliminating capable talent prematurely. "Talent in interior markets is often more stable and highly motivated," notes Rassense's Kumar. "Using English as the first screen means organisations never discover that capability."

English remains an essential tool for navigating international markets and boardrooms. However, Corporate India is dismantling the notion that polished English measures intelligence, judgement, or leadership instinct.

"English can help a leader participate in global conversations," notes executive presence coach Vikram. "It can't decide whether that leader deserves the opportunity."

The challenge is not to abandon English, but to ensure it remains a practical business tool rather than an informal gatekeeper to leadership. BT

CGC UNIVERSITY, MOHALI,
The New Architecture of Talent

FOCUS
EDUCATION

The future of education is no longer defined solely by what happens inside a classroom. As technology transforms industries, professions evolve and new skills emerge almost overnight, the distance between academic learning and the world of work is becoming increasingly consequential. Bridging that distance requires more than periodic interaction between universities and employers; it calls for a sustained dialogue in which both sides actively shape what comes next.

Against this backdrop, CGC University, Mohali, hosted the maiden Industry-Integrated Board (IIB) – Executive Leadership Dialogue 2026, bringing together representatives from more than 50 leading organisations for a wide-ranging conversation on talent, technology and the future of work.

Spanning technology, consulting, BFSI, automotive, manufacturing, analytics, enterprise solutions, retail and other emerging sectors, the participating organisations brought diverse perspectives to a common question: what should tomorrow's professionals know, and what should they be able to do?

The conversation moved beyond the traditional language of placements and recruitment. It examined the changing architecture of employability, from emerging technologies and evolving job roles to capability gaps, experiential learning and the growing importance of industry-recognised skills. The dialogue also explored how universities and organisations can work together through internships, live projects, professional certifications, mentorship, Centres of Excellence, research and innovation.

At the heart of the deliberations was a simple but consequential premise: curricula cannot remain static while the world of work continues to transform. Academic programmes must increasingly reflect contemporary industry realities, while students need opportunities to encounter authentic professional challenges before they graduate.

The dialogue also laid the groundwork for a structured IIB Strategic Action Agenda, identifying curriculum enhancement, capability development, industry-integrated learning, emerging technologies and sustained Industry, Academia engagement as key areas for action.

For students, this convergence has implications far beyond employability. It can create an educational experience in which knowledge acquires context, technology meets application and learning opens directly into opportunity.

The maiden IIB Executive Leadership Dialogue thus represents a shift from occasional industry engagement towards a more continuous model of co-creation. It recognises that the talent of tomorrow cannot be designed by academia or industry alone. It must be shaped together, through conversation, collaboration and a willingness to rethink what education should prepare young minds to become.

